18.14 Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT)

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "Will the electricity hurt my brain?" **Objective** • First • ECT booked • Restless	**ACTUAL** **Anxiety** related to ECT procedure as evidenced by fear and questions.	Says he is less anxious before treatment.	• Explain the procedure, the anaesthetic and what effects to expect. • Answer his questions honestly. • Make sure consent is obtained as the law and policy require.	Calmer: **goal met**.
Subjective • "Will I lose my memory?" **Objective** • Asks about side effects • Cannot say how to prepare	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge** related to ECT preparation and side effects as evidenced by questions.	Can describe how to prepare and what effects to expect.	• Teach fasting and taking out dentures and jewellery. • Explain that he may have short-term memory loss and a headache.	Describes them: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Has an anaesthetic • Confused after treatment	**RISK** **Risk for acute confusion** as evidenced by risk factors: anesthesia and seizure induction.	Oriented once he has recovered from each treatment.	• Watch vital signs and the airway after treatment. • Reorient him. • Stay with him until he is fully alert.	Oriented: **goal met**.